northern border. The Chief of General Staff (CGS), Major General Kulwant Singh, was drafted into the committee along with Brigadier Himmatsinhji who was the Deputy Director General, Military Operations in 1950, to study the problems arising out of the Chinese aggression in Tibet and make necessary recommendations.

The committee was to submit its report in two parts. The first part consisting of recommendations regarding Sikkim (which was an Indian protectorate, but retained administrative autonomy), Bhutan, NEFA and the Eastern frontier bordering Burma, was to be submitted in April 1951. The second part containing recommendations on Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Nepal was to be submitted by September 1951. The report was expected to cover not only the army and air force but also civil armed forces like the Assam Rifles which were under the Ministry of External Affairs.

A major part of the committee's recommendations focused on the Assam Rifles, which at the time was the only arm of the government in NEFA. Accordingly, the Assam Rifles was expected to defend the international border, maintain law and order in the tribal areas and take charge of internal defence at times when the police was unable to cope with the situation.

The report noted: 'It will be seen that the whole of the northern borderland is looked after by only two battalions, the 2nd and the 5th. The 2nd alone is responsible for the Siang, Dihang and Lohit valleys and the Tirap Frontier Tract, including the Ledo Road. The 3rd Battalion has the care of Naga areas, both in Assam State and the NEF Agency. The 1st is in the Lushai Hills and the 4th in Manipur. Five platoons, three in the Garo-Khasi Hills are serving outside their normal areas. In Manipur, besides the Assam Rifles battalions, there are the Manipur Rifles, a force of about 400 strong directly under the Chief Commissioner, who also has a police force. For the time being, a detachment from a regular battalion provides guards for the petrol pump, jail, etc. In Tripura State, the Old Tripura Rifles are now being reorganized as the 6th Battalion of the Assam Rifles. The enormous area to be covered in comparison with the limited size of the force has resulted in the wide dispersion in weak detachments. There are no fewer than 70 posts and in many cases platoons have been split to a quarter of their original size to man posts.'